

22, The Superficial Revival of Classical Society in Andalusia

Under Muslim rule in Andalusia, observers can note a rare, yet unessential, phenomenon. During the Umayyad dynasty's rule over Spain, the classical morphology seemingly experienced a temporary resurrection in the southwestern corner of the European continent; the prosperity of the economy, culture, and arts brought immense prestige to Andalusia during this period. After the collapse of the Western Roman Empire and centuries of Visigothic entry and rule over this region, the emergence of such a situation in Andalusia under Muslim rule indeed readily arouses curiosity. I believe this should be understood from two aspects.

Firstly, the historical trajectory of the Iberian Peninsula inherently cannot be deemed identical to that of the core region of Western Europe, namely the French territories ruled by the Frankish Kingdom. The Iberian Peninsula is dominated by plateaus and mountains; the central Meseta Central alone occupies 60% of the entire peninsula's area. It is said that many American Western films were shot in the arid regions of central Spain, where the population density is extremely low. Were it not for the sanctuary provided by Iberia's complex topographical features, the Christian kingdoms in the northern part of the peninsula might not have survived the vanguard of the Islamic armies. However, as previously stated, the cover of such mountainous and plateau-strewn geographical environments easily allows a massive number of **communities** (社群) to remain detached from state administration, making it difficult for rulers to influence them. Regions with developed agricultural economies were located in river valleys or coastal areas along the peninsula's periphery. This is a far cry from the conditions in France, where plains account for two-thirds of the national territory and are exceptionally suitable for agricultural production. During the early modern period from 1500 to 1700, although the area of the Iberian Peninsula was roughly comparable to that of mainland France, the population of the former was only about one-third of the latter's. Similarly distinguishing it from France, the Kingdom of Castile and the Spanish Kingdom lacked a fixed capital for a prolonged period, possessing only itinerant courts that moved with the monarch.

Prior to the Muslim conquest, the **feudalization** (封建化) process in Iberia under Visigothic rule was already proceeding rather slowly. If we take note of the history of the Visigoths themselves, this phenomenon is not the least bit surprising. This is because the Visigoths were precisely the first wave of **barbarians** (蛮族) to execute **Ru Guan / Entering the Pass** (入关) during the collapse of the **classical empire** (古典帝国). Having been in long-term contact with the empire, they understood its lifestyle, political architecture, and ideology; they could be considered "semi-Romanized" raw barbarians (生番). Consequently, the Visigoths leaned towards trying their utmost to maintain the old systems of the empire. In an era of universal urban decay, the Visigoths constructed several new cities and preserved Roman-era urban culture, such as public baths. The Visigothic Kingdom produced a cohort of outstanding scholars, most notably Isidore of Seville (who is also one of the most well-known medieval European scholars in China); the aristocrats and rulers were well-educated and zealous about preserving classical culture. These facts point to an obvious conclusion: before the Muslims conquered the vast majority of the Iberian Peninsula, the degree of **feudalization** in this region was not high, and the characteristics of a late-classical society (晚期古典社会) still persisted to varying degrees.

Secondly, the new changes brought by the Muslim conquerors were also conducive to the formation of the zenith landscape of Andalusia in the 10th century under the rule of the Caliphate of Córdoba. For instance, there were diversified **communities**, including the Umayyads who came here to rule,

the Berbers and European Slavs who arrived as military forces, and the Jewish communities that played a pivotal role in international trade. Several new technologies from the Near East were introduced to the Iberian Peninsula, leading to substantial development in both agriculture and handicrafts. The Iberian Peninsula was integrated into the trade network of the Islamic world, and the inauguration and prosperity of the trans-Saharan trade brought massive quantities of precious metal currency to the Córdoba regime, which was adjacent to North Africa. These changes, to varying degrees, contained the **natural economy** (自然经济), allowing the splendor of a **classical society** to reappear in this corner of Europe. Abd al-Rahman III, who elevated the Umayyad regime from an Emirate to a Caliphate, fully utilized all the aforementioned favorable factors to consolidate central fiscal and military power in order to re-establish authority.

However, such prosperity ultimately could not guarantee the eternal preservation of the Umayyad dynasty's realm. The feudal manorial economy had, after all, already developed in Iberia, and it would not be thoroughly suppressed merely due to Muslim rule. The high degree of commercial circulation in the medieval Islamic world could ultimately only serve as a hindrance to its progression toward an early modern and modern society. The fact is that the Caliphate of Córdoba merely possessed the hollow shell of a **classical empire**; in reality, it was completely incapable of organizing a "citizen army" like a genuine **classical empire**. Militarily, the empire relied excessively on mercenaries and slave armies, which is inherently a characteristic of the terminal phase of **classical empires**. (*The increasing dependence on mercenaries and slave armies reflected the state's inability to mobilize military resources directly from society.*) The Caliphate of Córdoba headed towards dissolution in the early 11th century, whereas the Christian kingdoms in the north—which had long been highly passive—genuinely began to develop a feudal system similar to other regions of Western Europe. Accompanied by the arrival of the **High Middle Ages** in Europe, the clarion call for the Christian reconquest of the peninsula was sounded.

22，安达卢西亚古典社会表面的复兴

在穆斯林统治下的安达卢西亚（Andalusia），人们观察到了一种难得的，但是并非本质的景象。在伍麦叶王朝统治西班牙时期，古典形态似乎在欧洲大陆的西南角暂时复活了，经济、文化和艺术的繁荣让这个时期的安达卢西亚享有盛名。在西罗马帝国瓦解，西哥特人进入并统治这个地区数个世纪后在穆斯林统治下安达卢西亚出现这种情况，的确容易引发人们的好奇。我认为应该从两个方面进行理解。

首先是伊比利亚半岛的历史进程本来也不能视为与西欧的中心地区，也就是法兰克王国统治的法国地区相同。伊比利亚半岛多高原和山脉，仅仅一个中央卡斯蒂利亚高原就占了整个半岛面积的六成，据说很多美国西部片都取景自西班牙中部的荒漠地区，那里人口密度极低。如果不是伊比利亚复杂地貌特征的庇护，半岛北部的基督教王国当年也未必能在伊斯兰大军的兵锋下存活下来。然而就如之前所说，这种山区高原遍布的地理环境掩护下容易使大量社群游离在国家行政之外，统治者难以影响他们。农业经济发达地区位于半岛边缘的河谷或者沿海地区。这与法国那种平原面积占国土 2/3，并且极为适宜农业生产条件差之远矣。在近代早期的 1500 年到 1700 年间，尽管伊比利亚半岛的面积和法国本土差不多大，但是前者的人口却只有后者的 1/3 左右。同样与法国不同的是，卡斯蒂利亚王国以及西班牙王国长期没有固定的首都，只有随着君主移动的行在。

在被穆斯林征服之前，西哥特王国统治时期的伊比利亚封建化进程就已经较慢。如果我们注意到西哥特人本身的历史，那么这种现象便丝毫不令人感到奇怪。因为西哥特人正是古典帝国崩溃时期第一波次入

关的蛮族，他们长期与帝国接触，了解帝国的生活方式、政治架构和意识形态，可以算是“半罗马化”的生番。因此西哥特人也就倾向于尽力维持帝国的旧有体制。在城市普遍衰落的年代，西哥特人兴建了一些新的城市，并保留了浴场这样罗马时期的城市文化。西哥特王国诞生了一批杰出的学者，以塞维利亚的伊西多尔最为知名（Isidro，他在中国也是知名度最高的中世纪欧洲学者之一），贵族和统治者的教育情况良好，并且热衷于维持古典文化。这些事实指向了一个显然的结论，在穆斯林征服伊比利亚半岛绝大部分地区之前，该地区的封建化程度并不高，晚期古典社会的特征或多或少仍然存在。

其次，作为征服者的穆斯林带来的新变化也有利于形成科尔多瓦哈里发国统治时安达卢西亚在十世纪的鼎盛景象。例如多元化的社群，包括来到这里统治的伍麦叶人，作为军事力量来此的柏柏尔人和欧洲的斯拉夫人，以及在国际贸易中发挥重大作用的犹太社区。一些来自近东地区的新技术被引进了伊比利亚半岛，农业和手工业都有了比较大的发展。伊比利亚半岛被接入伊斯兰世界的贸易网络中，跨撒哈拉贸易的开辟和繁荣为临近北非的科尔多瓦政权带来了大量贵金属货币。这些变化都在不同程度上遏制了自然经济，使得一种古典社会的辉煌再次出现在欧洲的角落。使得伍麦叶政权从一个埃米尔国发展成为一个哈里发的阿卜杜拉赫曼三世（Abd al-Rahman III）就充分利用了以上所有有利因素巩固中央的财政和军事力量以重建权威。

不过这样的繁华终归不能保证伍麦叶家族江山永固，封建庄园经济毕竟已经在伊比利亚发展起来了，而且并不会因为穆斯林的统治就被彻底压制。中世纪伊斯兰世界的高度商业流通最终只能作为其迈向近代社会的阻碍。事实就是科尔多瓦哈里发国家空有一个古典帝国的外壳，实际上完全不能像真正的古典帝国一样组织一支“公民军队”，帝国在军事上太过依赖于雇佣兵和奴隶武装，这原本就是古典帝国终结期的特征（即国家已经无法依靠其自身社会组织军事力量）。科尔多瓦哈里发国在 11 世纪初走向瓦解，长期以来在北方十分被动的基督教王国却真正开始发展出了类似于西欧其他地区的封建体制，伴随着欧洲中世纪盛期的到来，基督教重新征服半岛的号角吹响了。